CMI Change Management Interface

PROPOSAL FOR REVIEW

CMI IT Service Desk

One portal, three desks: **IT Requests**, **IT Incidents** and **Change Management**, built by configuring the CMI we already have.

IT Requests
"I need something": access, software, hardware

IT Incidents
"Something is broken": fix and restore

Change Management
"We need to change a system": plan, approve, implement

1 · SUMMARY

What was asked, and what we propose

The request is to see CMI as a proper IT service desk: three clearly separated sections instead of a list of form links, a flow like the reference diagram, and approval from the requester's Head of Department (HOD) by email.

The request

- The home page should show **big sections**: end users see IT Requests and IT Incidents; core users (the IT team) also see Change Management.
- Each section has its own **categories** (for example Access Request, Network Issue, Emergency Change) and its own steps from start to close.
- An incident can lead to a **change** when a permanent fix is needed.
- An admin keeps the **master settings**: categories, priority, SLA, workflows, approvers, support teams, statuses.
- A requester types their **HOD's email**. The HOD gets a link and approves or rejects from the email.

The short answer: most of this is configuration

CMI is already a **configurable** system. Every category becomes a **form**, and every approval chain is a **workflow**, set up by an admin on screen with no programming. Existing parts cover about two thirds of what is needed. Four additions complete it:

NEW

Three-section home page

Each form is placed in a section and shown under a large tile.

NEW

HOD approval by email link

The HOD approves with one click. No account or password is needed.

NEW

Support groups and SLA rules

Assign work to a team, with response and resolution targets for each type.

NEW

"Change required?" bridge

Raise a linked change request straight from an incident.

2 · HOW CMI IS CUSTOMIZABLE

CMI is a set of building blocks, not a fixed form

Think of CMI as a set of building blocks. An admin uses the same few blocks to make an IT request, an incident or a change. Nothing below needs a programmer; it is all done from the Administration screens.

1 · Form

The questions to ask. The admin adds fields such as text, dropdown, date, attachment or checkbox. **Each category is a form.**

EXISTS

2 · Workflow

Who approves, in which order. Stages can depend on answers, for example "only if Emergency".

EXISTS

3 · People and roles

Permission profiles: requester, assignee, approver, admin. One person can hold several.

EXISTS

4 · Notifications

Who gets an email when a ticket is created, changes status or needs approval.

EXISTS

5 · Tracking

Status, priority, due date, comments, attachments, full history, reports and CSV export.

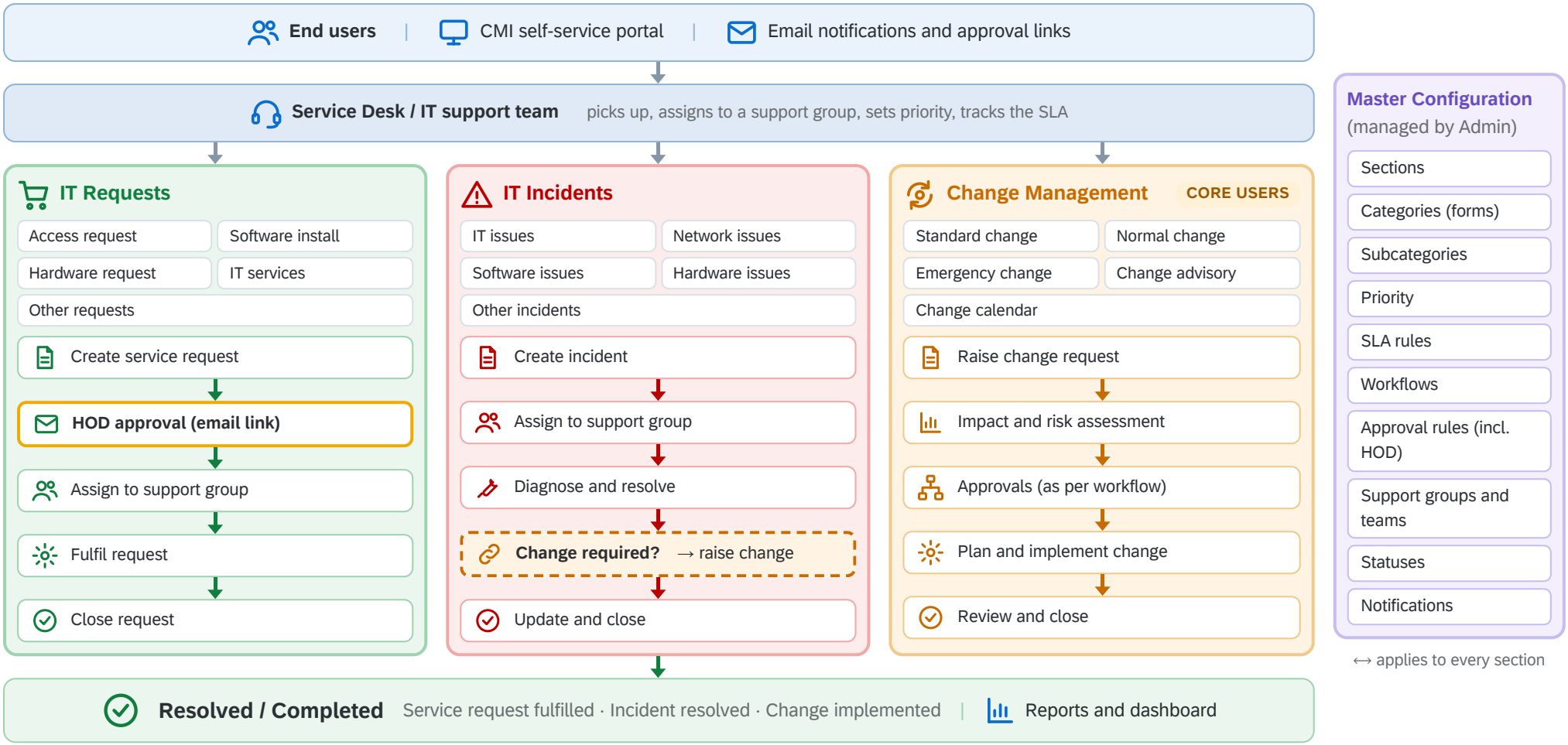
EXISTS

How the blocks combine into one ticket

1. **Requester picks a form** — e.g. "Software Installation"
2. **Fills the questions** — which the admin designed
3. **Workflow runs** — approvers are emailed in order
4. **IT team works on it** — assigned, prioritised, tracked
5. **Closed** — history kept for audit

Why this matters for the three sections: IT Requests, IT Incidents and Change Management are not three separate programs. They are three groups of forms, each with its own questions, approvers and closing step. Adding a new category later, such as "Printer Issue", takes minutes for an admin and needs no new development.

How a request moves through CMI



Amber outline: HOD email approval (new). Dashed box: incident-to-change link (new).

4 · HOME PAGE

Big sections instead of a list of links, by who you are

Today, forms appear as a list of quick links in one box. In the new home page they are grouped under large section tiles. **End users** see only what they need: IT Requests and IT Incidents. **Change Management** is for **core users**, the IT team.

END USER any employee, signs in with an email code

CMI IT Service Desk — Priya ▾

3 My open tickets | **1** Awaiting HOD

IT Requests
Ask for access, software, hardware

- Access Request ›
- Software Installation ›
- Hardware Request ›
- IT Services ›
- Other Request ›

My open: **2** · Awaiting HOD: **1**

IT Incidents
Report something broken

- IT Issue ›
- Network Issue ›
- Software Issue ›
- Hardware Issue ›
- Other Incident ›

My open: **1**

Below the tiles: My Tickets

CORE USER IT team, signs in with a password

CMI IT Service Desk — Search tickets — Shubham ▾

7 Assigned to me | **2** Waiting for my approval | **12** My group's queue | **1** Overdue (SLA)

IT Requests
Ask for access, software, hardware

- Access Request ›
- Software Installation ›
- Hardware Request ›
- IT Services ›
- Other Request ›

My open: **2** · Awaiting HOD: **1**

IT Incidents
Report something broken

- IT Issue ›
- Network Issue ›
- Software Issue ›
- Hardware Issue ›
- Other Incident ›

My open: **1** · Critical: **1**

Change Management
Core users only

- Standard Change ›
- Normal Change ›
- Emergency Change ›
- Change Calendar ›
- CAB Review Queue ›

Scheduled this week: **3**

Below the tiles: My Work · Administration · Reports (as today)

What changes: each form gets a **Section** setting, and the home page shows one large tile per section with its own colour, icon and counts.

Who sees what: each section has a **"Visible to"** setting: *everyone* or *core users only*. Change Management is set to core users only, so end users cannot see or raise changes.

Core users still raise requests and incidents for themselves, and work on everyone's tickets. The admin can change visibility at any time without development.

5 · SECTION 1

IT Requests: "I need something"

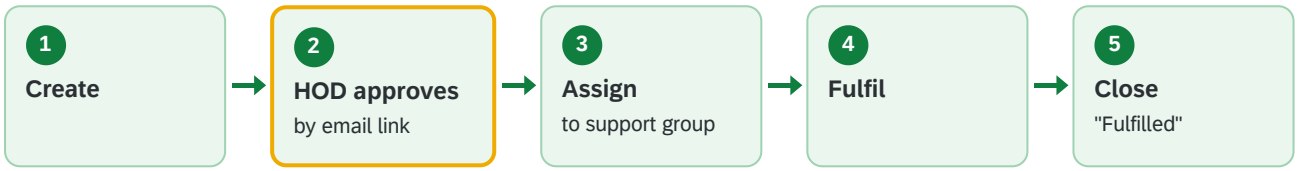
For planned needs such as access, software, hardware and services. These normally need the HOD's approval before IT acts.

Categories (each one is a form)

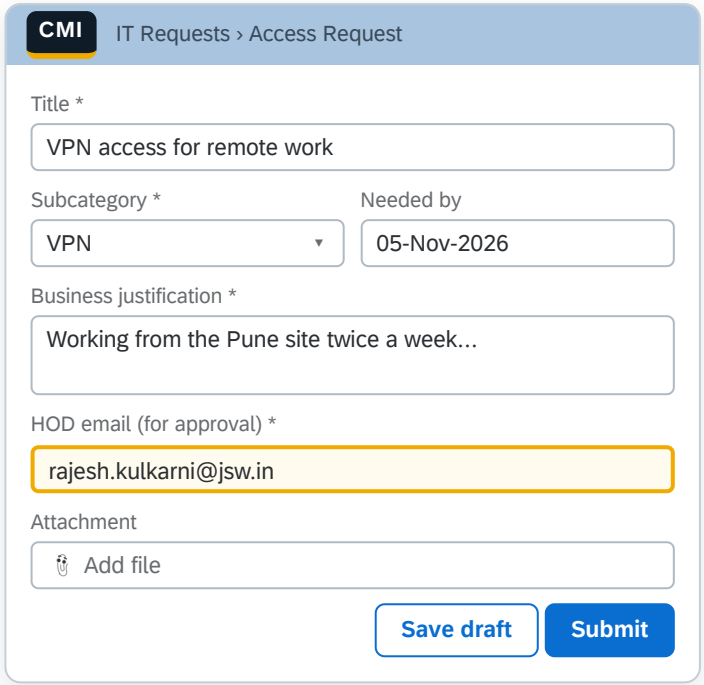
CATEGORY	EXAMPLE SUBCATEGORIES (DROPDOWN)	APPROVAL
Access Request	VPN, shared folder, application, email group	HOD
Software Installation	Licensed, free tool, upgrade	HOD, then IT Head if licensed
Hardware Request	Laptop, monitor, peripherals	HOD, then IT Head
IT Services	New joiner setup, email ID, backup restore	HOD
Other Request	Free text	HOD

"**then IT Head if licensed**" is a **conditional stage**, which CMI already supports: the stage runs only when the answer on the form matches the condition.

Flow



What the requester sees



IT Incidents: "Something is broken"

For unplanned problems. Speed matters more than approval, so incidents go straight to the support team. Priority and SLA decide how fast they must be handled.

Categories

IT Issue	login, email, printer
Network Issue	internet, Wi-Fi, VPN
Software Issue	crash, error
Hardware Issue	laptop, monitor
Other Incident	free text

Priority from two simple questions

WHO IS AFFECTED?	CAN WORK CONTINUE?	PRIORITY
Whole site / many users	No	**Critical**
A team	No	**High**
Just me	No	**Medium**
Anyone	Yes, with a workaround	**Low**

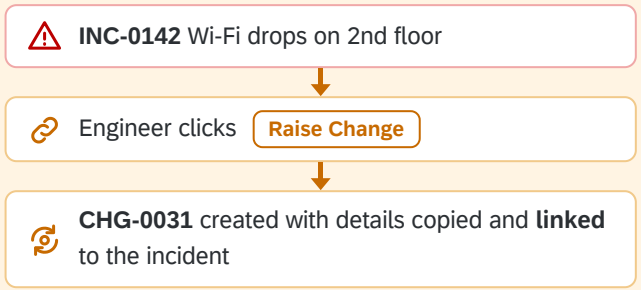
The service desk can still override the priority. CMI already records every priority change with a reason. The **SLA rule** for that priority then sets the response and resolution deadlines.

Flow

1. **Report**
2. **Assign** to support group
3. **Diagnose and resolve**
4. **Update and close** "Resolved"

"Change required?" bridge

Sometimes the quick fix is temporary and a permanent fix needs a change to a system, for example replacing a failing switch.



Both tickets show the link. When the change is implemented, the incident team is notified so they can close the incident.

Linking tickets already exists in CMI. The new part is the one-click "Raise Change" button that pre-fills the form.

7 · SECTION 3

Change Management: "We need to change a system"

Changes to servers, network, applications or configuration are planned, risk-assessed and approved before anyone touches production. The type of change decides how many approvals it needs. **This section is visible only to core users (the IT team)**; end users do not see it on their home page.

CHANGE TYPE	MEANING	APPROVAL PATH (CONFIGURED AS ONE WORKFLOW WITH CONDITIONS)
Standard	Routine, low-risk, done many times before (e.g. add user to a group)	PRE-APPROVED No approval needed; goes straight to implementation
Normal	Planned change with some risk (e.g. firewall rule, server patch)	HOD → Change Advisory Board (CAB) → IT Head
Emergency	Urgent fix to restore service, often coming from an incident	Emergency CAB (any one member can approve) → review after the fact

Flow

1. **Raise** — type, systems, reason
2. **Impact and risk** — downtime, rollback plan
3. **Approvals** — as per type
4. **Implement** — in planned window
5. **Review and close** — "Implemented"

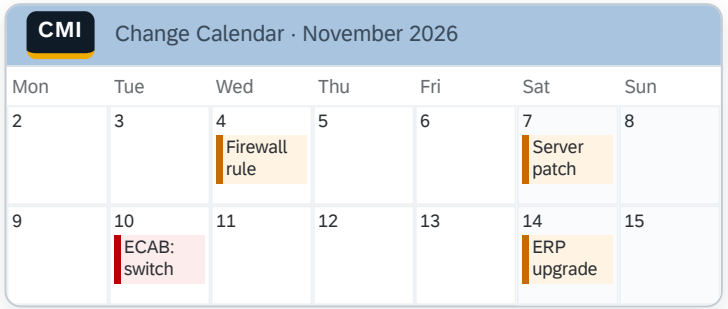
Form questions

- Change type
- Systems / services affected
- Reason and expected benefit
- Impact and risk (Low / Medium / High)
- Planned start and end, downtime yes/no
- Rollback plan, test evidence (attachment)

Already in CMI

- Multi-stage approvals, in order
- "Any one" or "everyone" must approve, which suits the CAB
- Approve, reject, or send back for changes
- Approval is redone if the form is edited after approval

Change Calendar NEW



Approved changes appear on their planned dates, so the CAB can spot clashes (two changes on the same system on the same night) before approving.

8 · HOD APPROVAL BY EMAIL

The requester names their HOD, and the HOD approves from email

The HOD does not need a CMI account or password. The email itself carries a secure, single-use approval link that is tied to that one ticket and that one email address.

1. **Requester submits** and types the HOD's email in the form
2. **CMI emails the HOD** a summary of the request and an approval link
3. **HOD opens the link** sees the full request, then Approve, Reject or Send back, with a comment
4. **Workflow continues** to the next approver or to the IT team
5. **Requester is notified** and the decision is saved in the ticket history

How the admin sets it up

- In the form, add a field of the new type **"Approver email"**, labelled "HOD email".
- In the workflow, add a stage **"HOD approval"**, approver: **"email from field: HOD email"**.
- The stage can be first, in the middle or conditional, like any other stage.
- Any form in any section can use it. It is not limited to IT Requests.

Safeguards

- Only **company email domains** are accepted. CMI already has this setting.
- The requester **cannot enter their own email** as HOD.
- The link works **once**, for **that ticket only**, and **expires** (suggested: 7 days).
- If the request is edited after approval, CMI asks the HOD again, as it already does for approvals today.

Convenience

- **Reminder** email if there is no decision after 2 days. The IT team can also resend it.
- CMI **remembers** the last HOD each user entered and pre-fills it next time.
- If the HOD is also a CMI user, the request appears in their **"Pending My Approval"** list too.
- Audit: who approved, when, from which link, with what comment.

8 · HOD APPROVAL BY EMAIL (SCREENS)

What the HOD sees

A The email in the HOD's inbox

Inbox

From: CMI Service Desk <cmi@jsw.in>
To: rajesh.kulkarni@jsw.in

Approval needed: REQ-0218 VPN access for remote work

Dear Rajesh,

Priya Deshmukh has named you as HOD and asked for your approval:

Section	IT Requests › Access Request
Subcategory	VPN
Needed by	05-Nov-2026
Justification	Working from the Pune site twice a week...

Review and decide

This link is for you only and expires on 04-Nov-2026. Do not forward it.

B The approval page (opens from the link, no login)

CMI Approval: REQ-0218 Secure link

VPN access for remote work PENDING HOD APPROVAL

Requested by Priya Deshmukh · 28-Oct-2026 · IT Requests › Access Request

Subcategory: VPN
Needed by: 05-Nov-2026
Justification: Working from the Pune site twice a week...
Attachment: manager_note.pdf

Your comment (required for Reject or Send back)

Reject Send back Approve

C After deciding

✓ **Approved. Thank you.** Priya and the IT team have been notified. This link can no longer be used.

What the admin controls

This is the purple "Master Configuration" box from the architecture page. The admin manages all of it from screens; none of it needs a developer.

MASTER	WHAT IT MEANS	STATUS	WHAT IS ADDED
Sections	The big desks on the home page: name, colour, icon, order, and **visible to** everyone or core users only	NEW	A section list, and a "Section" setting on each form
Categories	The kinds of ticket in a section, such as Access Request or Network Issue. Each is a form.	EXISTS	Nothing; forms already exist and are versioned
Subcategories	Finer choice inside a category, such as VPN or Wi-Fi	EXISTS	Nothing; this is a dropdown field in the form
Service types	Request, Incident or Change, which decides the default flow and closing word	EXTEND	Set on each section
Priority	Critical, High, Medium, Low	EXISTS	Optional: impact and urgency questions that suggest a priority
SLA rules	Response and resolution targets per section: by category for requests, by priority for incidents, by type for changes	NEW	Targets, warnings, escalation and a report (page 12). Due dates already exist.
Workflows	The ordered approval stages for each form, with conditions	EXISTS	Nothing
Approval rules	Who approves each stage: named users, "any one" or "all"	EXTEND	Approver "HOD email from form" (page 9)
Support groups and teams	Network team, Desktop support, Application team; a ticket goes to a team and any member can pick it up	NEW	Groups with members. Today a form has one default assignee.
Statuses	The steps a ticket passes through	EXTEND	Closing label per section: Fulfilled, Resolved or Implemented
Notifications	Who is emailed and when	EXISTS	New events: HOD reminder, SLA about to breach
Users and permissions	Who can create, assign, approve, administer	EXISTS	Nothing

SLA rules for each type

Each section measures something different. Incidents are about restoring service fast, requests are about delivering on time, and changes are about deciding and implementing safely. The admin can change every target below; they are suggested starting values.

IT Requests

Targets by **category**. The clock starts **after HOD approval**.

CATEGORY	RESPOND	FULFIL
Access request	4 h	1 day
Software installation	4 h	2 days
Hardware request	4 h	5 days*
IT services	4 h	2 days
Other request	1 day	3 days

* If hardware must be purchased, the clock pauses while it is "Waiting for procurement".

IT Incidents

Targets by **priority**. The clock starts **when the incident is reported**.

PRIORITY	RESPOND	RESOLVE	HOURS
Critical	15 min	4 h	24×7
High	1 h	8 h	Office
Medium	4 h	2 days	Office
Low	1 day	5 days	Office

"Respond" means a support person has picked up the ticket and contacted the user.

Change Management

Targets by **change type**: how fast it is decided and closed.

TYPE	DECISION	CLOSE AFTER IMPLEMENTING
Standard	None (pre-approved)	Done within 2 days
Normal	CAB within 5 days	Review within 2 days
Emergency	ECAB within 2 h, 24×7	Review within 1 day

Changes are also checked against their **planned window**: running past the planned end time is flagged.

How the SLA clock works (same for all three)

Office hours

Counted only during office hours (suggested Mon–Sat, 9:30–18:30, excluding holidays), except rows marked 24×7. "Day" means one working day.

Clock pauses

While waiting on someone outside IT: HOD approval, "Returned" to the requester for more information, or waiting for procurement.

Warning at 75%

Email to the assignee and the support group lead. The ticket turns amber in lists and on the home page.

Breach at 100%

Email to the IT Head. The ticket turns red and counts as "breached" in the SLA report for each section, group and person.



Compared with the reference (ManageEngine-style help desk)

The full help-desk model in the reference has more modules. We start with the three that matter most and leave room for the rest.

Service requests

IN SCOPE

Section 1: IT Requests

Incident requests

IN SCOPE

Section 2: IT Incidents

Change management

IN SCOPE

Section 3: Change Management

Reporting

IN SCOPE

Existing dashboard plus per-section and SLA figures

Problem management

LATER

Can be a 4th section ("Problems") using the same blocks

Asset management

LATER

Hardware and software register; separate module

Knowledge base LATER

FAQs and known solutions, shown when someone reports a common issue, which can reduce tickets. Useful once enough resolved incidents exist to write articles from.

Configuration database (CMDB) LATER

Register of servers, network devices and applications, and how they depend on each other. For now, "Configuration Management" means the admin masters on page 11.

≈ ⅔ **of the proposed system already exists in CMI today**: forms, multi-stage and conditional approvals, statuses, priority, assignment, linking, attachments, comments, history, notifications, permissions, reports. The work is mainly the **three-section home page**, the **HOD email approval**, **support groups and SLA**, the **incident-to-change button** and the **change calendar**.

Reference: manageengine.com, "What is help desk software"

12 · ROLLOUT

Delivered in three steps, each usable on its own

Each phase ends with something management can see and use. Timelines will be confirmed once the decisions on the next page are made.

PHASE 1

The three desks

- Sections master and the tiled home page: end users see 2 sections, core users see 3
- All 15 category forms set up (5 per section) with their questions
- Workflows for each, including Standard / Normal / Emergency change rules
- Closing labels: Fulfilled, Resolved, Implemented
- Per-section counts on the home page and in reports

Shows the customizable nature: almost all of this phase is **configuration**.

PHASE 2

HOD approval and teams

- "Approver email" field and "HOD from form" workflow stage
- Secure single-use email link and the approval page
- Reminders, resend, and remembering the last HOD
- Support groups and teams; "assign to group"; group work queues

PHASE 3

Service levels and linking

- SLA rules for each type, 75% warnings, breach escalation and an SLA report
- Incident priority from "who is affected / can work continue"
- "Raise Change" from an incident (pre-filled and linked)
- Change calendar

LATER (OPTIONAL)

Extras

- Knowledge base / FAQs
- Problem management as a 4th section
- Asset register / CMDB
- Creating tickets from incoming email

13 · DECISIONS NEEDED

Points to confirm before development starts

#	QUESTION	OUR SUGGESTION	WHY IT MATTERS
1	Is the HOD email **typed by the requester**, or picked from a maintained list of departments and HODs?	Typed, pre-filled with the last one used	A list needs someone to keep it up to date, while a typed email can contain mistakes. Domain checks reduce the risk.
2	Should the HOD approve **without logging in** (link only), or confirm with a one-time code?	Link only, single-use, expires in 7 days	A code is safer if emails get forwarded but adds a step for busy HODs. CMI's sign-in codes can be reused if wanted.
3	Which categories need HOD approval? Do **incidents** ever need it?	All IT Requests and Normal changes; incidents never	Approval on incidents slows down restoring service.
4	Who sits on the **Change Advisory Board** and the Emergency CAB? Is one approval enough, or must all approve?	CAB: all members; ECAB: any one	Sets up the change workflows.
5	**SLA targets** for each type (page 12), office hours and holidays, and who gets escalations?	Start from page 12; Critical incidents and Emergency changes run 24×7	Decides when tickets show as overdue.
6	Which **support groups** exist, and who is in each?	Desktop, Network, Applications, Infra	Decides where tickets land.
7	Final list of **categories and questions** for each section	Start with the 15 shown here	Easy to change later; forms are versioned.

Suggested next step: approve Phase 1. Because it is mainly configuration, the three-section home page with working forms can be demonstrated first, before the new HOD approval is built.